





Speak gently! – It is better far
To rule by love, than fear
Speak gently – let not **harsh** words mar
The good we might do here!



Speak gently! – Love **doth whisper** low
The vows that true hearts bind;
And gently Friendship's **accents** flow;
Affection's voice is kind.



Speak gently to the little child!
Its love be sure to gain;
Teach it in accents soft and mild:-
It may not long remain.





Speak gently to the young, for they
Will have enough to bear –
Pass through this life as best they may,
'T is full of **anxious** care!





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